Category Policy Addendum: Apparel

KARTWAY OPERATIONAL POLICY MANUAL
SECTION 4: CATEGORY-SPECIFIC ADDENDA
ADDENDUM 4.8: APPAREL & FOOTWEAR DIVISION
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Mandatory Compliance for All Tier-1 and Tier-2 Support Agents

4.8.1 Return Window 1. The standard return window for all items listed under the Apparel & Footwear category is strictly 45 calendar days from the verified delivery date. This matches the general marketplace return window under Policy 2.1. 2. Return requests initiated on or after the 46th calendar day shall be automatically rejected by the automated support portal and must not be overridden by agents unless Systemic Escalation Protocol EP-9 applies.

4.8.2 Category-Specific Condition Requirements 1. Returned apparel items must pass physical inspection under the following strict criteria: * Hygiene Seals: Items sold with hygiene liners (including swimwear and undergarments) must have the original hygiene seal completely intact and unpeeled. * Odour and Residue: Items bearing any trace of body odour, perfume, deodorant marks, foundation, pet hair, or food stains are classified as *Failed Condition* and are ineligible for refund. * Tags: Brand-issued cardboard swing tags and woven care labels must remain physically attached via the original plastic fastener or security loop. Items with detached tags are subject to refusal. 2. Footwear returns must meet all conditions in Clause 4.8.2(1) and additionally satisfy: * Soles: Soles must be entirely free of outdoor wear, dirt, scuffs, or pebble embedding. Inspections must be performed on a clean white surface. * Creasing: Shoes exhibiting severe upper leather creasing indicative of extended wear beyond indoor sizing trials shall be rejected.

4.8.3 Original Packaging Mandate 1. Original manufacturer packaging—including branded shoe boxes, dust bags, polybags with barcode SKU stickers, and cardboard collar inserts—is not mandatory for standard apparel returns (e.g., t-shirts, jeans, outerwear). 2. Original packaging is strictly mandatory for footwear and luxury accessories (defined as items with an MSRP exceeding $150.00). 3. If footwear is returned without the original branded shoebox, or if the shoebox was used directly as the external shipping container (with shipping labels affixed directly to the manufacturer box), a mandatory packaging devaluation penalty of $12.50 shall be deducted from the customer's refund total.

4.8.4 Restocking Fees 1. Standard apparel and footwear returns processed within the 45-day window incur $0.00 in restocking fees. 2. A mandatory restocking fee of $6.75 applies to any bulk apparel return containing 5 or more distinct SKU items from a single order, designed to offset manual sorting and

repackaging labor at the fulfillment depot. This fee is automatically deducted from the total refund amount.

4.8.5 Hazardous or Perishable Handling Rules 1. Standard apparel items contain no hazardous materials and are not perishable. 2. Heated Apparel Exception: Garments containing integrated lithium-ion battery packs (e.g., heated vests, heated gloves) are classified as restricted hazardous items. * Customers attempting to return heated apparel must be directed to use ground-only transit flags in the return portal. * Batteries must be disconnected from the garment and placed inside a non-conductive interior pocket before boxing. * Damaged, swollen, or leaking lithium-ion batteries associated with apparel must never be mailed back; agents must issue an immediate photo-verified instant refund and instruct the customer to dispose of the battery at a local hazardous waste facility in accordance with regional environmental codes.

4.8.6 Warranty Period 1. The manufacturer defect warranty period for all Kartway Apparel & Footwear items is 180 calendar days from the date of purchase, superseding the 90-day general merchandise warranty. 2. The warranty covers structural manufacturing failures, including broken zippers, compromised seam stitching, button detachment under normal tension, and sole separation. 3. The warranty explicitly excludes normal wear and tear, fabric pilling, fading due to improper laundering contrary to care label instructions, and accidental snags or tears. 4. Valid warranty claims filed between Day 46 and Day 180 shall be settled via replacement SKU dispatch or full platform credit, at the discretion of the reviewing Tier-2 logistics agent. Cash refunds are not issued for warranty claims processed after the 45-day return window.